The Measure Of Time



As watch collecting becomes one of India's biggest luxury fascinations, knowing what to buy and what is worth keeping comes down to far more than rarity, waiting lists or resale value.

BY JEHANGIR READYMONEY

A watch can look wonderful in a photograph and still be entirely wrong on the wrist. That is where I would begin any conversation about collecting today.

Before asking whether a reference is difficult to obtain, ask whether you actually enjoy wearing it. Does the case sit comfortably? Can you read the dial? Does it suit your personality? Those questions sound almost too simple for an expensive purchase. Yet, they often tell us more than another discussion about so-called waiting lists.

My own interests have always returned to proportions, case design, and the character of older watches. That does not mean a collection must be vintage. Some of the most appealing contemporary pieces understand restraint exceptionally well. Patek Philippe's Calatrava 6196P, for instance, combines a 38mm platinum case with a rose-gilt opaline dial, and its small seconds and clean display give the eyes a bit of room to settle. Remember, the pleasure is in the relationship between the details rather than the price tag or snob value.

Jaeger-LeCoultre makes a similar argument through a very different shape. The Reverso Tribute Monoface measures 40.1 by 24.4mm and is only 7.56mm thick. These measurements matter because a rectangular watch cannot be judged by the same shorthand we use for a round one. Its length, width, and how the case meets the strap all influence



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